FOR HR & MOBILITY TEAMS · NOV 2026

How your staff pass the Cyprus culture exam

Как вашим сотрудникам сдать экзамен на знание Кипра: памятка для HR

The Ministry of Education exam “Basic Elements of the Contemporary Political and Social Reality of Cyprus” is required for Cypriot citizenship by naturalisation and for long-term residence. A free one-page guide.

Why it matters for your relocated staff

Since the Civil Registry (Amendment) Law 2023 took effect on 19 December 2023, **highly skilled employees of companies on the Council of Ministers' list** can apply for naturalisation after **12 months' continuous residence plus 3 years (Greek B1) or 4 years (Greek A2)** in the previous ten, about **4 or 5 years in total** [5][6]. The standard route needs 12 months + 7 years and Greek B1 [5]. Both routes require **at least 60% in this exam** [1][5]. Long-term residence needs 50% in the same exam [1]. Fast-track applications should be processed within 8 months [7].

Ускоренная натурализация для высококвалифицированных сотрудников: 12 месяцев + 3 года (B1) или 4 года (A2), то есть около 4–5 лет. Но экзамен на знание Кипра (≥60%) обязателен на любом пути.

The exam at a glance

Language	**Greek only** [1]
Format	Multiple choice, **45 minutes** [1]; 25 questions as reported by Cyprus Mail [8]
Pass mark	**60%** for citizenship (15/25), 50% for long-term residence [1][8]
Fee	**€20**, paid through JCC Smart when applying [1] [2]
On the day	ID card / passport / ARC and the candidate card; no phones, smartwatches, notes or dictionaries [9]
Syllabus	14 topics, from current affairs and history since 1960 to holidays and transport [4]

Только на греческом, 45 минут, 25 вопросов, проходной балл 60%, взнос €20 через JCC Smart.

Dates and application windows

Exam (Saturday)	Application window (one week, JCC Smart)	
21 Nov 2026	5–12 Oct 2026	closed
6 Mar 2027	**11–18 Jan 2027**	**next window**
3 Jul 2027	17–24 May 2027	
20 Nov 2027	4–11 Oct 2027	

The exam now runs **three times a year**. Each application window is **one week**; staff who miss it wait months [2][3].

Окно подачи заявлений: всего одна неделя. Ближайшее: 11–18 января 2027 (экзамен 6 марта).

What HR can do (10 minutes of work)

1. **Add the 2027 windows to the team calendar** now, with a reminder a week before each one opens.
2. **Tell staff that the Greek certificate is a separate exam.** A2 or B1 is held in Cyprus once a year, in May [9]; this culture exam is extra.
3. **Share the free practice test:** 15 questions in Greek, each with English and Russian translation and an explained answer. cyprus-exam-prep.github.io/?utm_source=hr
4. **Optional: cover preparation for a team.** The full pack has 99 questions in Greek with EN/RU translations, 2 timed mock exams and a glossary. **Team licence: 10 seats €80 + VAT** · TEAM_LICENCE_URL

Бесплатный тест из 15 вопросов с переводом на английский и русский. Командная лицензия: 10 мест за €80 + НДС.

[1] Ministry of Education, Examination Service: exam page (45 min, multiple choice, Greek, 50%/60%, €20 via JCC Smart): https://www.moec.gov.cy/ypexams/exams/pistopoiisi_eparkous_gnosis_vasikon_stoicheion_pragmatikotitas_kyprou.html
[2] Examination Service announcement, 22 Sep 2026: sitting 21 Nov 2026, applications 5–12 Oct 2026, three sittings a year: https://enimerosi.moec.gov.cy/archeia/1/ypp20532a
[3] Examination Service, 2027 programme (22 Sep 2026): 6 Mar, 3 Jul, 20 Nov 2027 and application windows: https://enimerosi.moec.gov.cy/archeia/1/ypp20531a
[4] Examination Service: official syllabus (14 topics): https://archeia.moec.gov.cy/mc/544/exetastea_yli_eparkis_gnosi_vasikon_stoicheion_pragmatikotitas_kyprou.pdf
[5] Ministry of Interior: naturalisation qualifications, form M127 (standard and highly-skilled routes; ≥60% certificate; fees): https://www.gov.cy/moi/en/documents/acquisition-of-cypriot-citizenship-by-naturalization-due-to-years-of-residence-form-m127/
[6] Civil Registry Law 141(I)/2002, s.111B (CyLaw): https://www.cylaw.org/nomoi/enop/ind/2002_1_141/section-sc5a59f6fe-c0fd-6b06-9d3f-952dbce6e858.html
[7] European Commission, Migration and Home Affairs: 'Cyprus: New citizenship legislation' (fast-track processing up to 8 months): https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu/news/cyprus-new-citizenship-legislation-2024-03-06_en
[8] Cyprus Mail, Theo Panayides, 19 Jul 2026 (25 questions; 60% = 15; Greek wording): https://cyprus-mail.com/2026/07/19/trying-to-trick-people-with-cheap-gotchas-the-cyprus-citizenship-exam
[9] info.cy, 'Exams for long-term residence and Cypriot citizenship' (what to bring; centre and time sent by email): https://info.cy/cyprus-citizenship-and-residence-exams

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